

Northwind Support Handbook

This handbook describes how the fictional Northwind support team handles refunds, escalations and data requests. It is sample material written for FlowAid and may be redistributed freely.

1. Refunds

Customers may request a refund within 30 days of purchase. Refunds up to \$200 are approved by the support agent. Refunds above \$200 and up to \$1,000 need approval from a team lead. Refunds above \$1,000 need approval from the finance department and are paid within 10 business days.

2. Escalations

A ticket is escalated when the customer reports data loss, a security issue, or when it has been open for more than 72 hours. Escalated tickets are answered within 4 business hours.

3. Data requests

Requests to export or delete personal data are forwarded to the privacy team within 1 business day. The privacy team completes deletion requests within 30 days, as required by policy NW-PRIV-2.

4. Service levels

First responses are sent within 8 business hours for standard plans and within 2 business hours for premium plans. Premium customers have a named support contact.

5. Tools

The support team uses the ticketing system for all customer contact. Phone calls are logged as tickets within 1 hour. Chat transcripts are kept for 90 days.

6. Revisions

Version 3 of this handbook changed the team-lead refund limit from \$500 to \$1,000. The previous limit applied until 1 March 2026.